Uploading posts as JSON

A complete guide for TechWorld Blog: how a post file is laid out, what every field needs, how to add images and sources, how to upload, and how to fix every error the studio can show.

For the studio at `localhost:3000/studio`. Last updated 27 October 2026.

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1. The short version

1. **Start from a template.** In the studio go to **Import JSON** and press a button under *Start from a template* (Explainer, How-to, Review and so on). It fills in every required field.
2. **Fill it in** in a text editor such as VS Code or TextEdit (plain text mode), then save it as a file ending in `.json`.
3. **Upload images first** through the studio editor, or put them in `public/images/<slug>/`, and reference them in `media`.
4. **Upload the file** with **Choose .json files**. Do not paste long JSON copied from a terminal or chat window.
5. **Import as a draft first**, open it with **Edit**, read it, fix anything listed under *Before you can publish*, then press **Publish**.

> **The one rule that saves most problems:** upload files, do not paste. Copying from a terminal or chat inserts hidden line breaks into long lines, which breaks the JSON with a "Bad control character" error.

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2. What a post file is

Every post on the site is one JSON file in the project's `content/` folder. The studio form, the JSON tab in the editor and the Import page all produce exactly the same file, and all go through the same checks. Posting with JSON and posting with the form are interchangeable.

Kind	Saved in	Web address
Article (explainer, how-to, comparison, troubleshooting, news analysis)	`content/articles/<slug>.json`	`/articles/<slug>`
Review	`content/reviews/<slug>.json`	`/reviews/<slug>`
Buying guide	`content/pillars/<slug>.json`	`/guides/<slug>`
Static page	`content/pages/<slug>.json`	`/<slug>`

The Import page accepts three shapes:

```
One post:        { "type": "article", ... }
Several posts:   [ { ... }, { ... } ]
Or:              { "docs": [ { ... }, { ... } ] }
```

JSON rules that trip people up

- Every key and every text value is in straight double quotes: `"title": "My post"`. Curly quotes from Word or Pages break it.
- Items in a list or object are separated by commas, but there is **no comma after the last one**.
- A new paragraph inside text is written as `\n\n`, not a real line break.
- A double quote inside text is written as `\"`. An apostrophe needs nothing special.
- `true`, `false`, `null` and numbers have no quotes.
- One post per file, unless you deliberately use the list shape. Pasting a post inside another post is the most common cause of a broken file.

3. Every field and its rules

Field	What to put	Rule
`schemaVersion`	Always `1`	Added for you if missing
`type`	`article`, `review`, `pillar` (buying guide) or `page`	Required
`format`	Articles only: `explainer`, `how-to`, `comparison`, `troubleshooting`, `news-analysis`	Required for articles
`slug`	The web address, e.g. `what-is-wi-fi-7`	Lowercase letters, numbers and single hyphens. Must be unique
`locale`	`en-GB`	Or `en-US`
`status`	`draft` or `published`	The Import page can override it
`title`	The headline and Google title	10 to 80 characters
`metaDescription`	The snippet under the title in Google	70 to 165 characters
`excerpt`	Short summary on the home page and in lists	40 to 300 characters
`author`	`{ "name": "...", "slug": "editorial-team" }`	The slug must exist in `content/authors.json`
`dates.published`	`YYYY-MM-DD`, e.g. `2026-10-27`	Not in the future
`category`	One of: `phones`, `computing`, `tvs`, `audio`, `wearables`, `cameras`, `smart-home`, `gaming`, `networking`, `evs`	Required except for pages
`tags`	`["wi-fi", "routers"]`	Lowercase with hyphens. Optional
`answer`	The plain answer to the title, two or three sentences	Articles only. At least 40 characters
`sections`	The body, as a list of `{ id, heading, body }`	At least one. Each `id` unique
`media`	Pictures. The first one is the main image	Each needs `src` and `alt` (8+ characters)
`faq`	`[{ "q": "...", "a": "..." }]`	Question 8+ and answer 20+ characters
`sources`	Every website you took a fact from	Each needs `id`, `name`, `licence`; add `url`
`editorial.aiAssisted`	`true` if an AI tool helped draft it	Shows a disclosure line on the page
`_note`	Private notes to yourself	Never shown on the site

Unknown or misspelled field names are rejected on purpose, so a typo such as `"titel"` shows up as an error instead of being silently ignored.

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4. What each kind of post needs

A draft can be saved with parts missing. These extra rules apply when you publish:

Kind of post	Extra things it must have before publishing
Explainer	Nothing extra. List your sources.
How-to	At least 2 `steps`, and a `testing` block with `versionTested` (the exact app or OS version).
Comparison	2 to 4 `products`, and a `testing` block.
Troubleshooting	A `testing` block saying what you tried it on.
News analysis	A source with a `url` (the original news), and one section with `"opinion": true`.
Review	`product`, `verdict` (summary, bestFor, skipIf, at least one pro and one con), `testing`, and 2+ sections.
Buying guide (pillar)	At least one section; `picks` must point at reviews that exist.
Static page	At least one section. Slug must not clash with a site address such as `reviews` or `studio`.

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5. Writing the body text

The `body` of a section, the `answer` and the steps use Markdown:

You write	You get
`**bold**`	**bold**
`*italic*`	*italic*
`[link text](/categories/phones)`	a link
`- item` on its own line (after `\n`)	a bulleted list
`1. item` on its own line	a numbered list
`\n\n`	a new paragraph

Each section needs a unique `id` made of lowercase letters and hyphens, for example `"what-changes"`. It becomes the link to that part of the page.

6. Adding images

Where the picture is used

- The **first item in the top-level `media` list** is the main image: at the top of the article, on the home page and as the share picture.
- Images inside a section (`sections[].media`) appear within that section. If `media` is empty, the first section image is used as the main image instead.

Getting the file into the project

1. **Easiest:** import the post as a draft, open it with **Edit**, press **Add media** then **Upload**. The file is saved to `public/images/<slug>/` and the size is filled in for you.
2. **By hand:** copy the image into `reviewkit/public/images/<slug>/` and write its path starting from `/images/` (not `public/`).

```
"media": [
  {
    "src": "/images/what-is-wi-fi-7/router.jpg",
    "alt": "A Wi-Fi 7 router on a shelf with its status lights on",
    "credit": "Own photo",
    "width": 1600,
    "height": 900
  }
]
```

- **alt** is required: describe what the picture shows, at least 8 characters. Not "image" or a file name.
- **credit**: "Own photo" or "Own screenshot" only for your own pictures. Otherwise name the source, and only use pictures you have the right to use.
- **width** and **height** are the real pixel size. Aim for at least 1200 pixels wide (Google Discover needs it).
- Accepted types: PNG, JPEG, WebP, AVIF and GIF, up to 8 MB each.

7. Sources and licences

Every fact you took from somewhere else needs a source entry. Never copy another site's wording; take the fact and write it yourself.

```
"sources": [
  {
    "id": "google-privacy-policy",
    "name": "Google Privacy Policy (effective 16 October 2026)",
    "url": "https://policies.google.com/privacy?hl=en-GB",
    "licence": "Facts only, linked to the original",
    "attribution": null,
    "fetchedAt": "2026-10-27"
  }
]
```

Where the fact came from	Use this licence text
GOV.UK, ICO, legislation.gov.uk, Ofcom	`Open Government Licence v3.0`
Wikipedia	`CC BY-SA 4.0 (facts only; no text reused)`
A company's own page (Google, Samsung, Sony)	`Facts only, linked to the original`
A news site or blog	`Headline and link only`

- **id**: a short unique name, lowercase with hyphens. Reviews use it to tie a spec to its source.
- **url**: must start with `https://`. Open it yourself before publishing to check it loads.
- **fetchedAt**: the date you read it, as YYYY-MM-DD.
- For **news analysis**, the first source should be the original: the company's own announcement, policy page or forum post, a regulator, or GOV.UK. Not another site's coverage of it.

8. Uploading the file

1. Sign in at `localhost:3000/studio` with your login id and password from `.env.local`.
2. Under *Start something new*, choose **Import JSON** (or go to `/studio/import`).
3. Press **Choose .json files** and select one or more files. The panel shows how many posts it found.
4. Choose the **Status**:
   - **Save as drafts**: recommended for a first upload. Nothing appears on the site.
   - **Publish**: live straight away if every check passes.
   - **Use the status in the JSON**: follows each file's `status`.
5. Tick **Replace existing** only when you are updating a post that is already there.

6. Press **Import**. Each post is listed as saved, with **Edit** and **view** links, or as not saved with the reasons.
7. Open the draft with **Edit**, read it, add images, then press **Publish**. The right-hand panel lists anything still needed; click an item to jump to it.

Several posts at once: choose several files together, or put them in one file as a list. Posts that pass are saved; posts that fail are reported and skipped, so one bad post does not stop the rest.

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9. Updating, downloading and deleting

- **Update a post from JSON:** import the new version with the same `slug` and tick **Replace existing**.
- **Get a post's JSON:** open it in the editor, go to the **JSON** tab and press **Download JSON** (or **Copy JSON**). In the studio list, tick posts and press **Download JSON** to get several at once. Downloaded files can be imported again unchanged.
- **Publish, unpublish or delete in bulk:** in the studio list use the filters (category, type, status, AI-assisted), tick **Select all** and press **Publish**, **Move to draft** or **Delete**.
- **Deleted posts are not erased.** They move to `content/.trash/`. To restore one, move its file back into its folder (for example `content/articles/`) and remove the date from the end of its name. A post that another post links to cannot be deleted until the link is removed.
- **Keep a backup:** download your posts as JSON from time to time, or commit the `content/` folder to Git.

10. Errors and how to fix them

Message you see	What it means	How to fix it
Not valid JSON: Bad control character in string literal	Line breaks got inside the text while copying from a terminal or chat.	Save the JSON as a `.json` file and use **Choose .json files**. Do not paste.
Not valid JSON: Unexpected token / Expected ',' or '}'	A comma, quote or bracket is missing or extra, or two posts were pasted inside each other.	Check the line it names. Every item except the last in a list needs a comma after it.
A article called "..." already exists	A post with this slug is already on the site.	Tick **Replace existing**, or change the `slug`.
Required	A required field is missing or empty.	Fill in the field the message names.
Too short / Too long	A text field is outside its allowed length.	Check the length rules in section 3.
Wrong format	A slug, date or link is in the wrong shape.	Slugs: lowercase and hyphens. Dates: YYYY-MM-DD. Links start with https://.
news analysis must link its original source	The `sources` entry has an empty `url`.	Add the full link to the original news (Google's, Samsung's or a regulator's own page).
clear 1 marker(s) first: REPLACE: ...	A placeholder such as `REPLACE:`, `[GAP: ...]` or `[UNVERIFIED: ...]` is still in the text.	Replace it with real content. Placeholders in `_note` are ignored.
remove "TODO" before publishing	The word TODO is still somewhere in the post.	The message names the field. Replace the TODO text.
category "..." is not in content/categories.json	The category is misspelled or does not exist.	Use one of the ten category slugs in section 3.
image not found at public/images/...	The `src` points at a file that is not in the project.	Upload the image first (section 6), then use its exact path. This is a warning, not a block.
Sections, item 1, Media, item 1, Alt text: Required	An image has no description.	Add `alt` text that says what the picture shows.

If the site reads from the Neon database (`CONTENT_SOURCE=neon`), run `npm run content:import` after uploading so the database picks up the new files.

11. Checklist before publishing

- The file is saved as `.json` and opens in a text editor as one post (or a list of posts).
- `slug` is lowercase with hyphens and not used by another post (or **Replace existing** is ticked).
- Title, meta description and excerpt are within their lengths.

- `category` is one of the ten category slugs.
- `author.slug` is `editorial-team` (or another profile in `authors.json`).
- Every fact from elsewhere has an entry in `sources` with a working `url` and the right licence.
- News analysis: the original news is linked, and one section has `"opinion": true`.
- No `TODO`, `REPLACE:`, `[GAP: ...]` or `[UNVERIFIED: ...]` outside `_note`.
- Images are uploaded to `public/images/<slug>/`, each has real `alt` text and an honest `credit`.
- The main image is the first item in the top-level `media` list, at least 1200 pixels wide.
- `editorial.aiAssisted` is `true` if AI helped draft it.
- You have read it through once on the site preview after importing as a draft.

12. A complete example

A minimal explainer that passes every publishing check. Upload `router.jpg` to `public/images/what-is-wi-fi-7/` first, or remove the `media` block.

```
{
  "schemaVersion": 1,
  "type": "article",
  "format": "explainer",
  "slug": "what-is-wi-fi-7",
  "locale": "en-GB",
  "status": "draft",
  "title": "What is Wi-Fi 7, and do you need it?",
  "metaDescription": "What Wi-Fi 7 adds over Wi-Fi 6 and 6E, which devices can use it,
and whether upgrading your router will make any difference at home.",
  "excerpt": "Wi-Fi 7 routers are now on sale. Here is what the new standard adds, and
when it is worth upgrading.",
  "author": { "name": "TechWorld Blog Editorial Team", "slug": "editorial-team" },
  "dates": { "published": "2026-10-27" },
  "tags": ["wi-fi", "routers"],
  "category": "networking",
  "editorial": { "aiAssisted": false, "updates": [] },
  "answer": "Wi-Fi 7 adds wider channels, faster modulation and the ability to use
several bands at once. You only benefit if your phone or laptop also supports it and your
broadband is fast.",
  "media": [
    {
      "src": "/images/what-is-wi-fi-7/router.jpg",
      "alt": "A Wi-Fi 7 router on a shelf with its status lights on",
      "credit": "Own photo",
      "width": 1600,
      "height": 900
    }
  ],
  "sections": [
    {
      "id": "what-changes",
      "heading": "What changes",
      "body": "Wi-Fi 7 doubles the widest channel to **320MHz** in the 6GHz band.\n\n-
Faster modulation\n- Multi-link operation"
    }
  ],
  "faq": [
    { "q": "Will a Wi-Fi 7 router work with old devices?", "a": "Yes. Older devices
connect using the standard they support." }
  ],
  "sources": [
    {
      "id": "wiki-wifi7",
      "name": "Wikipedia: Wi-Fi 7",
      "url": "https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wi-Fi_7",
      "licence": "CC BY-SA 4.0 (facts only; no text reused)",
      "fetchedAt": "2026-10-27"
    }
```

```
  ]
}
```

To make other kinds of post, start from the matching template on the Import page rather than editing this example: each template already contains the extra fields that kind of post needs.